SESSION 2 · INDUSTRY INNOVATION

SHEIN

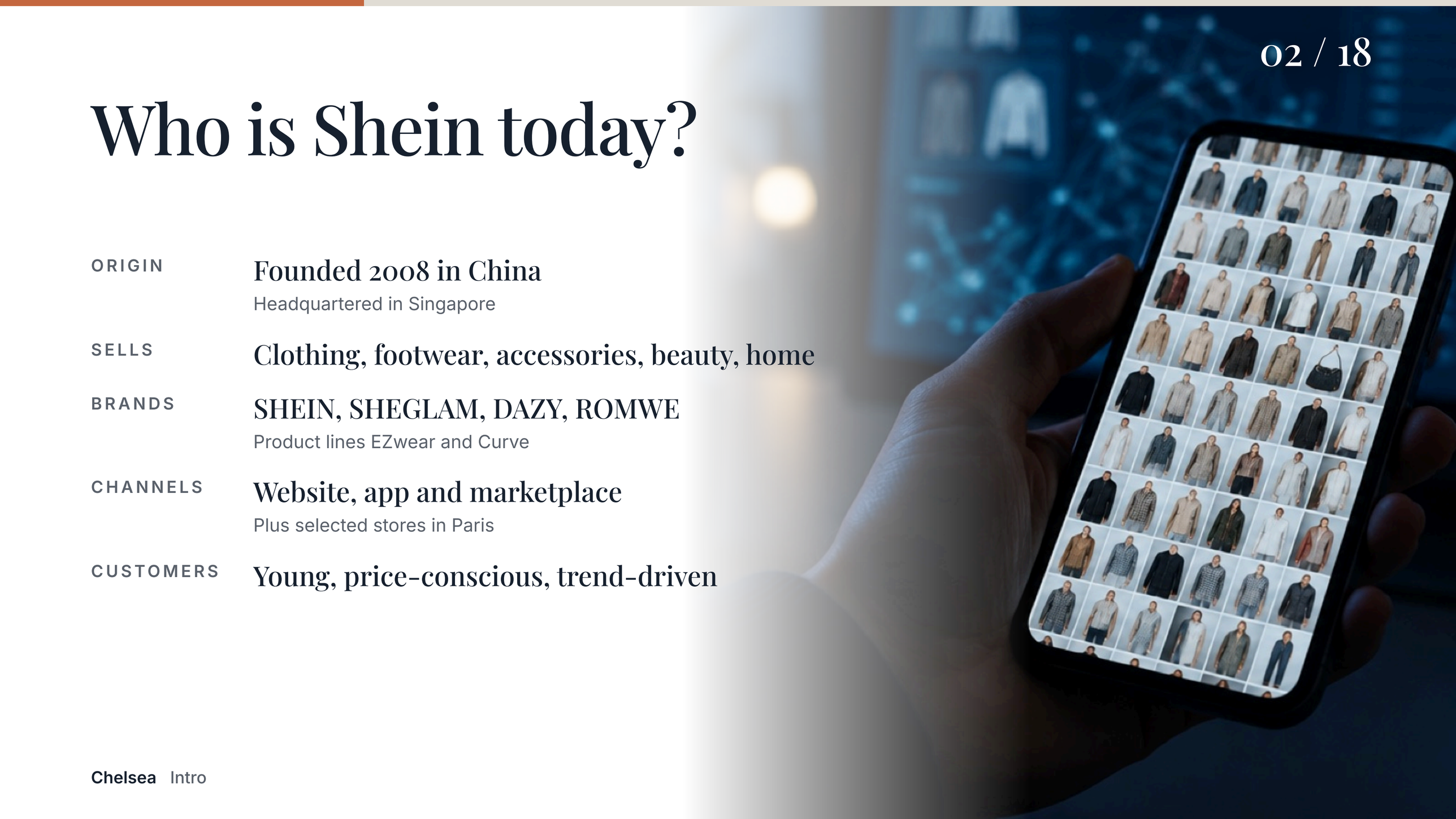
When the world changes faster than the model.

Strategies for Sustainable Business
Professor Marc Francés · EADA Business School

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October 2026

Who is Shein today?

ORIGIN	Founded 2008 in China Headquartered in Singapore
SELLS	Clothing, footwear, accessories, beauty, home
BRANDS	SHEIN, SHEGLAM, DAZY, ROMWE Product lines EZwear and Curve
CHANNELS	Website, app and marketplace Plus selected stores in Paris
CUSTOMERS	Young, price-conscious, trend-driven



Shein in numbers

160
markets worldwide

298M
orders in Q2 2026 · **+7.6%** year over year

US$813M
net cash from operating activities (June 2026)

16,000+
people have joined the team worldwide

40+
offices, from Singapore to Paris and London

Pressure from every side

P

POLITICAL

Duty-free small parcels are ending

NEGATIVE

E

ECONOMIC

Growth, profit and valuation are falling

NEGATIVE

S

SOCIAL

Tolerance for fast fashion is shrinking

NEGATIVE

T

TECHNOLOGICAL

AI helps everyone, rules demand traceability

MIXED

E

ENVIRONMENTAL

Emissions up 23% in one year

NEGATIVE

L

LEGAL

Over €210 million in fines since 2025

NEGATIVE

Political

No more duty-free small parcels in the US and EU

€3 duty per product in EU

Geopolitical positioning of Shein

Forced-labor politics concerning Xinjiang cotton

4.6bn

low-value parcels entered the EU in 2024, **over 90% from China**

Economic

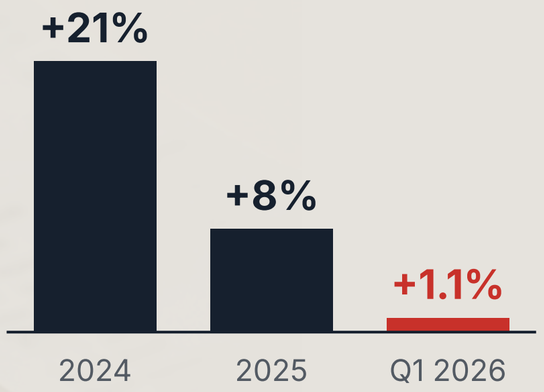
Custom duties and handling fees

Price-sensitive consumers shop elsewhere

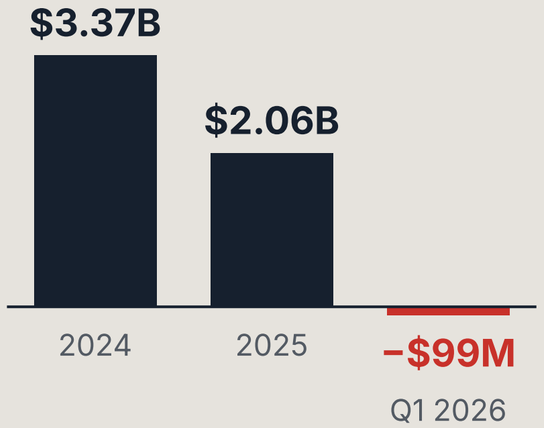
Results:

- ↘ Growth is slowing
- ↘ Profit has dropped
- ↘ Shein's valuation has shrunk by half

Revenue growth is slowing



Net income is falling ($ billion)



$100B → *$40–50B*

Valuation halved
2022 → now

Social

Public and political tolerance for fast fashion is shrinking

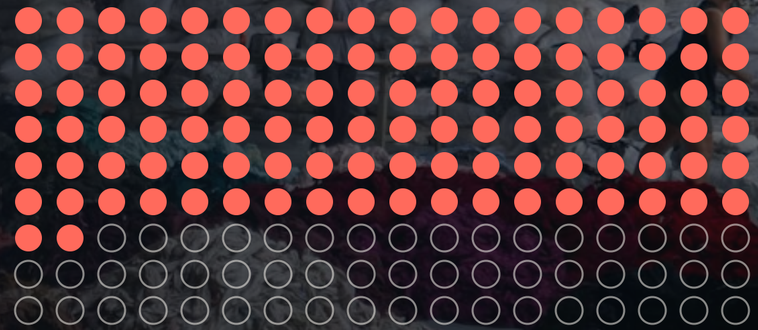
Product safety is lacking

Illegal products on Shein's website

Unreasonable labor conditions

The norms are changing

110 of 162



items from Shein and Temu failed EU standards in tests by a German testing body, including unsafe toys and toxic metals in jewelry.

Technological

Platform and AI technologies

They lower the cost of personalization and trend detection, for everyone

Regulatory technology requirements are growing

EU digital product passports and traceability rules

Textile-to-textile recycling is maturing slowly

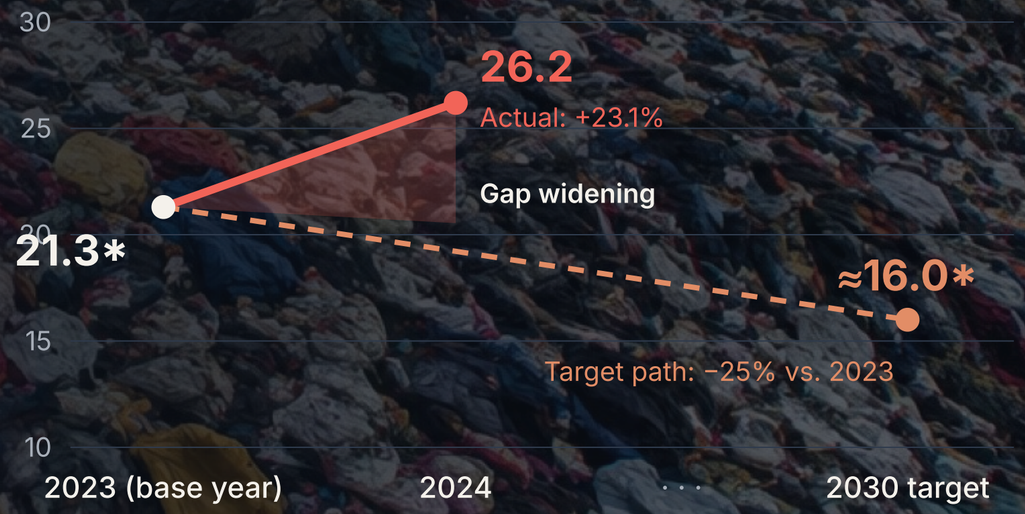
Recycled supply is still limited, but improving

Environmental

- Emissions up 23% in one year
- Speed = air freight
- Only 9% recycled polyester
- Throwaway culture and textile waste
- Efforts exist, but growth outpaces them

Emissions are moving *away from the target*

Shein's emissions vs. its own target (million tonnes CO2e)



*Calculated from Shein's own figures: 26.2 Mt in 2024 is +23.1% vs. 2023; the SBTi target is a 25% cut in Scope 3 by 2030 vs. 2023. Source: Sustainability Magazine; Shein Group.

Legal

Record fines: over €210 million since 2025

EU Digital Services Act: up to 6% of turnover

France and the EU now regulate ultra-fast fashion by law

Forced-labour import bans

Copyright lawsuits

Over *€210 million* in fines since 2025

Shein's fines in Europe since 2025 (€ million)



Today's fines are small compared with what is coming. Max DSA fine = 6% of 2025 revenue of $41.8 billion. Sources: CNIL; Caixin; Euronews; Lewis Silkin.

03

SWOT

Inside the company

Strategic position

S STRENGTHS

- Affordable pricing
- High production speed
- Expansive product assortment
- Social media marketing
- App design



W WEAKNESSES

- Long shipping times
- Poor customer service
- Disreputable brand image
- Inconsistent quality
- Unethical labor practices



O OPPORTUNITIES

- Physical retail channels
- Online marketplace expansion
- Brand acquisitions





T THREATS

- New environmental rules
- Sanctions on ultra fast fashion
- ESG repercussions
- Intense competition





Three numbers, two sides

STRENGTH

2,000–10,000

new products per day

WEAKNESS

7,667

complaints to the Better Business Bureau in the last 3 years

WEAKNESS

75h

work weeks, with severe underpayment and exposure to toxic chemicals and PFAs



04

Strategy

The way forward

The challenges behind Shein's growth

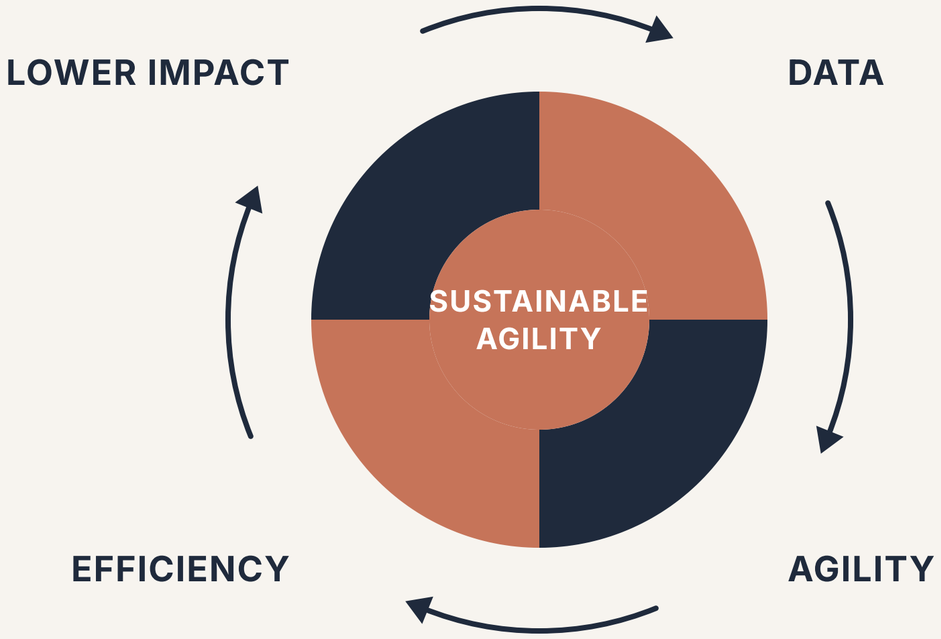
Growth	Slowing momentum
Legitimacy	Regulation · Reputation
Business model	Low price · High volume · High impact



Source: Statista (company filing), "Shein Faces Growth Challenges Ahead of IPO", CC BY-ND

Shein must scale growth *without scaling impact.*

What should Shein's strategy be?



KEEP

Data
Speed
Agility
Digital

CHANGE

Materials
Suppliers
Waste

From fast growth → *sustainable growth*

The world around Shein is changing *faster than Shein.*

THANK YOU · QUESTIONS

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